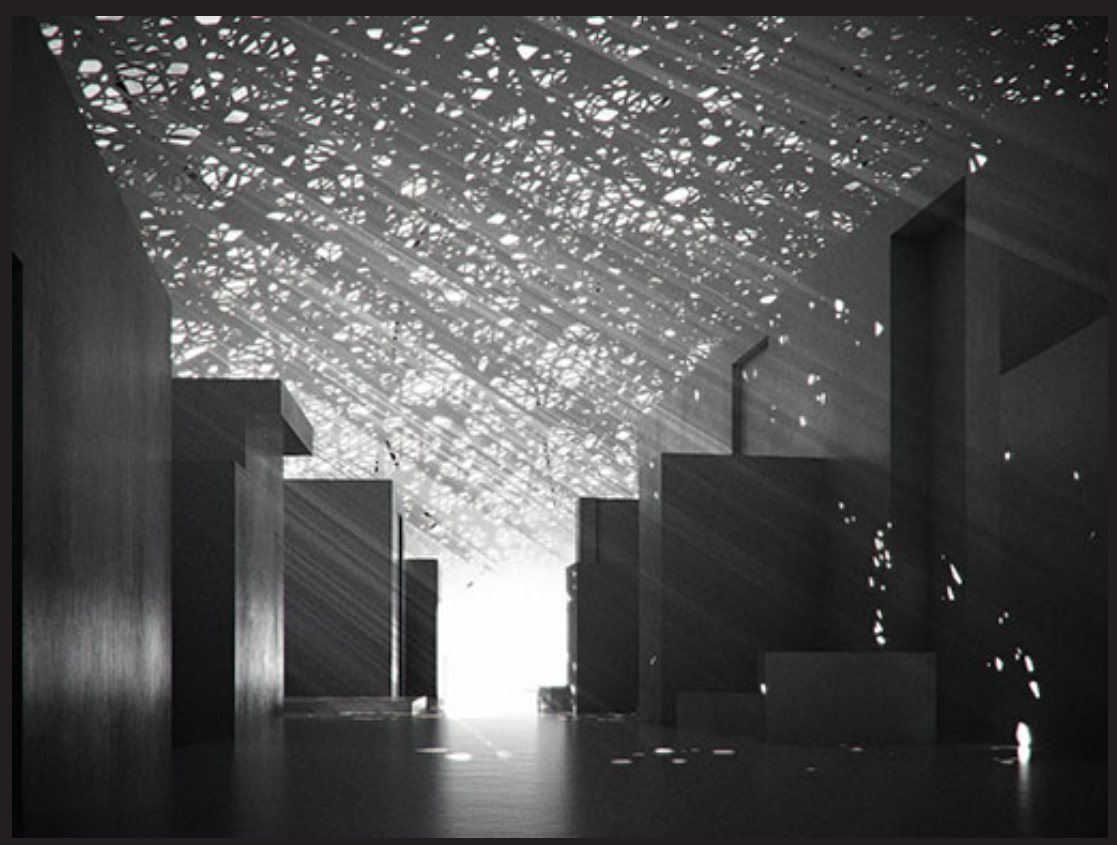
JEAN NOUVEL

Homepage



Jean Nouvel (born 12 August 1945) is a French architect. Nouvel studied at the École des Beaux-Arts in Paris and was a founding member of Mars 1976 and Syndicat de l'Architecture. He has obtained a number of prestigious distinctions over the course of his career, including the Aga Khan Award for Architecture (technically, the prize was awarded for the Institut du Monde Arabe which Nouvel designed), the Wolf Prize in Arts in 2005 and the Pritzker Prize in 2008. A number of museums and architectural centres have presented retrospectives of his work.

Family and Education

Nouvel was born on 12 August 1945 in Fumel, Lot-et-Garonne, France, the son of Renée and Roger Nouvel who were teachers. His family moved often when his father became the county's chief school superintendent. His parents encouraged Nouvel to study mathematics and language, but when he was 16 years old he was captivated by art when a teacher taught him drawing. Although he later said he thought that his parents were guiding him to pursue a career in education or engineering, the family reached a compromise that he could study architecture which they thought was less risky than art.

Practice

By age 25, Nouvel completed school and entered into his own partnership with François Seigneur. Parents sent them work, and gave Nouvel a valuable recommendation to the chairperson of the seventh edition of the Biennale de Paris[5] where for fifteen years, Nouvel designed exhibits and made contacts in the arts and theater.[4] Early on in his career, Nouvel became a key participant in intellectual debates about architecture in France: he co-founded the Mars 1976 movement in 1976 and, a year later, the Syndicat de l'Architecture. Nouvel was one of the organizers of the competition for the rejuvenation of the Les Halles district (1977) and he founded the first Paris architecture biennale in 1980.

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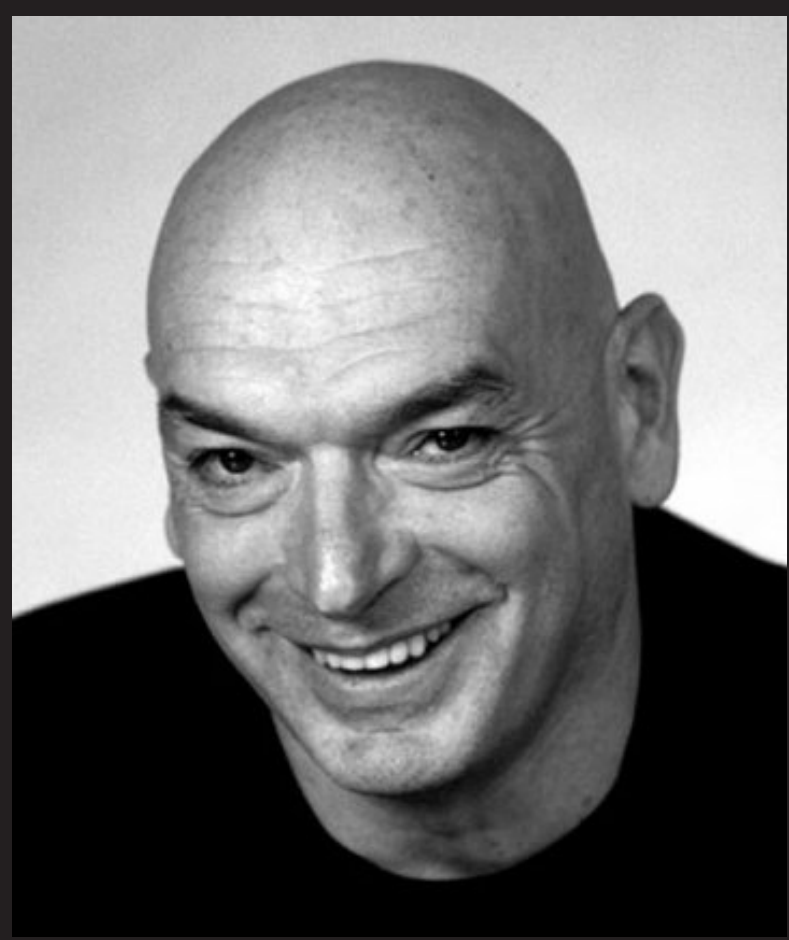
Biography



Jean Nouvel's projects transform the landscapes in which they are built, often becoming major urban events in their own right. His unique approach, driven by the specificities of context, program, and site has proven effective in numerous successes around the world.

Institut du Monde Arabe

One such success, a building that first brought Nouvel international recognition is the Institut du Monde Arabe (IMA) in Paris where one of its facades is made entirely of mechanical oculi operated by photoelectric cells that automatically open and close in response to light levels. The French critic, Alain de Gourcuff, said of it, "The overall effect is at once highly decorative in a Middle Eastern way and projects state-of-the-art electronics."

Film Director

That "theatricality" is no accident. Nouvel has often compared his role as architect to that of the film director. In an interview published in El Croquis in 2002, he said, "Everything is theatrical. I have worked for a long time as a scenographer, even on social housing ... scenography is the relationship between objects and matter that we want to display to somebody who is watching. In effect, in every building there is a way of proving a three-hundred-and-sixty degree view over the landscape, as in Lucerne. The use of the word scenography doesn't bother me as long as it is used in the right sense." In other interviews, he has often said that architecture and the cinema are very close.

JEAN NOUVEL

Gallery

Arab World Institute
1981-1987
Architecture

Cologne Tower
1999-2001
Architecture

Culture and Convention Center, Lucerne
1998
Architecture

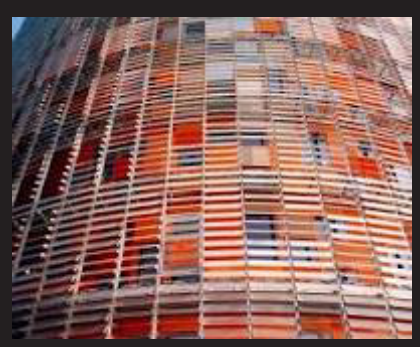
Fondation Cartier pour l'Art Contemporain
1991-1994
Architecture

Musee du quai Branly
2006
Architecture

One New Change
2010
Architecture

Doha Tower
2005-2012
Architecture

The Koncterhuse
2009
Architecture



Torre Agbar
2005
Architecture

Opera_Nouvel.jpg
1985-1993
Architecture

JEAN NOUVEL

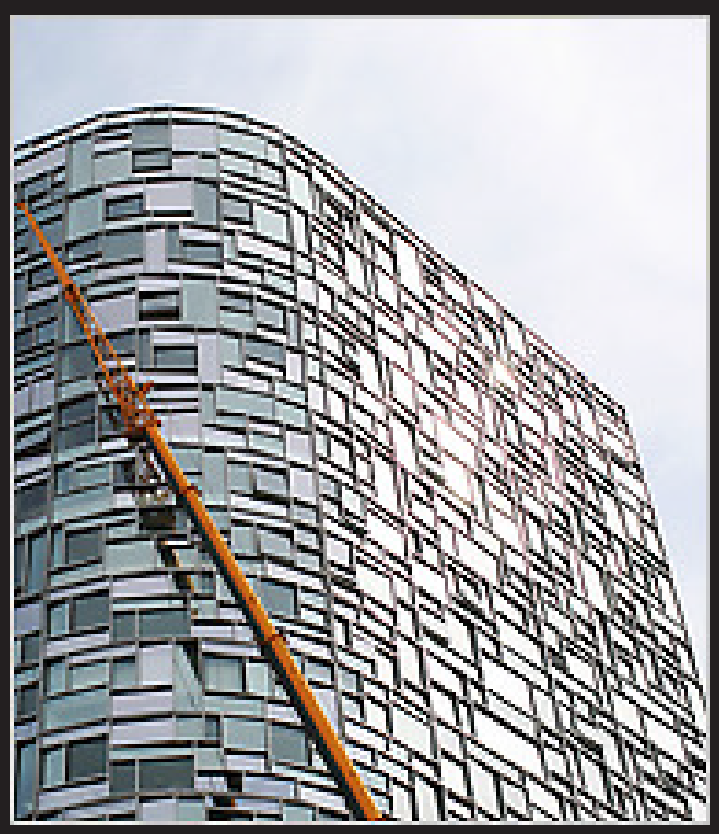
Links

Visit Jean Nouvel's personal website!

Learn more about Jean Nouvel!

New York Times

What New York Times has to say about Jean Nouvel!



Wikipedia

Wikipedia Jean Nouvel!